

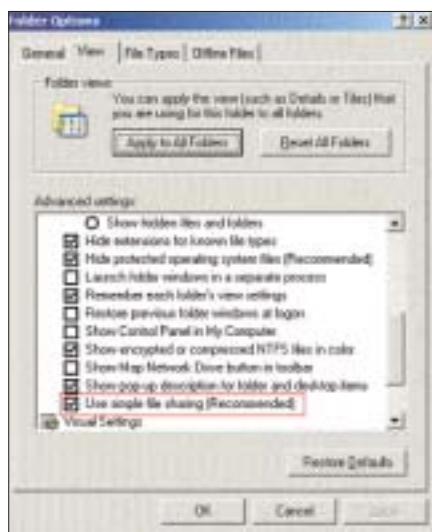


Check the 'Share this folder on the network' checkbox in the Sharing tab to share the folder

and more importantly, documents created by them should be visible only to them. The accountants also need to share critical financial data with their auditor over the network. Make sure that the operating system is installed on an NTFS partition for the following to work, and that simple file sharing is turned off. Also, the partition where the data is going to be stored has to be in the NTFS format.

All about users

There are some pre-defined users in Windows XP, such as the administrator, guest and two more users for providing remote help—HelpAssistant and Support. The administrator has full control over



You will need to disable the Simple file sharing option to access advanced sharing features

Creating an NTFS Partition

NTFS (New Technology File System) is an advanced file system that is used by Windows XP, 2000 and NT. The most important NTFS feature is the ability to encrypt files and folders to protect your data. It also supports large volumes and powerful storage solutions such as RAID. Existing FAT16 and FAT32 partitions can be converted to NTFS partitions without losing any data. If you use other operating systems, such as Windows 9x, or Linux, it's preferable to have Windows installed on a FAT32 partition, since an NTFS partition does not support multi-booting.

The command line tool in Windows XP allows you to convert an existing FAT32-based partition into a NTFS partition. Go to the command prompt, and enter '**Convert volume /FS:NTFS**'. Here, volume is your drive letter, followed by a colon.

If you try to convert the partition, in which Windows is installed into NTFS, the conversion will start when you restart the system. Note that there is no built-in utility to convert NTFS to FAT32, so be careful before you change your file system.



the system. You cannot delete the administrator account; in fact, you can't delete any of the built-in users and groups. The guest account has the lowest privileges in the system—it provides minimal access to the system. By default, the guest account is turned off.

Users can be classified under different groups, based on the privileges that are assigned to them. In the example being discussed, your system should have two groups—accountants and designers. Privileges can be assigned specifically to each group. Hence, the designers will only be allowed to run photo-editing applications, while the accountants will be provided exclusive privileges to view the balance sheet. Whenever you create a user, add him or her to the corresponding group. By doing so, the new user is automatically assigned the rights that are provided to that group.

You can create users in two ways. The simpler method is through the Control Panel. Go to **Control Panel > User Accounts**. From here, you can create new users, assign the rights they are privileged to

and make changes to existing ones, provided that you have administrative privileges. You can also create a user, either with administrative privileges, or as a limited user.

Power users is also a pre-defined group that has more privileges than the normal user, but less than an Administrator—he or she can rename and modify only the users they have created. To create a power user, or a user with more specific privileges, right-click My Computer, and select Manage. In the left pane of the window that appears, expand 'Local Users and Groups'. Select Users, and a list of all the users created for the system will be displayed. You will find entries such as Administrator, Guest and HelpAssistant. These are all in-built users that cannot be deleted. Create a new user by right-clicking in the right pane, and selecting New User. Here, enter the username and the values for some optional self-explanatory fields, such as the Password, and the 'User must change password at the next logon' field, etc. By default, any user created in this manner will become a member of the Users group.

In the left pane, below the users entry, you will find the Group entry.

TIP Use the Local Security Settings tool that is present in the Administrative Tools folder in the Control Panel to have greater control over the PC. In the tool, select **Local Policies > User Rights Assignment**. You will find a list of policies, and a list of users and groups assigned to it. Right-click a policy, and select Properties to make changes to it.